

# JOAN WAKARIA

Human Resource Professional

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896-00900 Kenya

<https://www.linkedin.com/in/joan-wakaria-49a2ba1b1/>



## PROFILE

Strategic and results-driven Human Resources professional with 7 years' progressive experience managing HR operations across recruitment, payroll, performance management, policy development, and employee engagement. Proven ability to align HR strategies with organisational goals, lead HRIS implementation, and drive organisational development initiatives. Adept at managing change, fostering a positive workplace culture, and delivering measurable improvements in HR efficiency and compliance. Skilled at working in fast-paced, diverse environments while maintaining the highest standards of integrity and ethical leadership.

## EDUCATION

Bachelor of Commerce (Human Resource Management) – Kenyatta University, 2022

Diploma in Human Resource Management – Kenyatta University, 2015

## CORE SKILLS

- Strategic HR Planning & Policy Development
- Recruitment & Talent Acquisition
- Employee Relations & Conflict Resolution
- Performance Management & Training
- Payroll & Benefits Administration • HRIS Implementation & Compliance
- Change Management & Organisational Development
- HR Metrics, Reporting & Audits
- Leadership & Cross-Functional Collaboration

## PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIP

Member – Institute of Human Resource Management (IHRM), Kenya

## ACHIEVEMENTS

- Developed and integrated a Photography Policy into employee contracts to prevent legal risks.
- Implemented recognition programmes that improved employee morale and company culture.
- Reduced recruitment timelines by 30% through ATS implementation and process optimisation.

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

### HUMAN RESOURCE CONSULTANT | January 2026 - Present

- Provide HR advisory support across HR operations, employee relations, performance management, recruitment, policy development and compliance.
- Conduct HR audits to identify gaps in employee documentation, contracts, leave records, policies and HR processes, and implement corrective measures to strengthen HR governance and compliance.
- Review and develop HR policies and procedures to improve consistency, accountability and alignment with organisational requirements and employment legislation.
- Streamline recruitment processes by introducing structured systems that improve efficiency, reduce delays and support timely workforce growth.
- Strengthen performance management through continuous performance monitoring, feedback, follow-up and employee support.
- Introduce employee recognition and engagement initiatives that promote appreciation, accountability and improved performance.
- Support managers in identifying performance gaps and implementing appropriate interventions to improve employee effectiveness and productivity.
- Provide guidance on employee relations, workplace concerns and people-management practices while maintaining confidentiality and professionalism.

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## African Population and Health Research Center (APHRC) | Head Recruiter

January 2025– December 2025

### Key Responsibilities:

- Collaborated with research team leads and HR to understand staffing needs for multiple ongoing research projects.
- Developed and posted job descriptions on various platforms to attract top research and administrative talent.
- Screened CVs, conducted initial interviews, and coordinated the selection process for roles ranging from research assistants to senior analysts.
- Facilitated end-to-end recruitment processes including scheduling interviews, gathering interview feedback, and extending job offers.
- Maintained a candidate database and tracked recruitment metrics for internal reporting and audits.
- Ensured hiring practices complied with APHRC's values, diversity goals, and donor requirements.
- Supported onboarding processes in collaboration with the HR and project management teams.
- Successfully filled huge numbers within tight timelines, improving project staffing efficiency.
- Contributed to enhanced candidate experience through clear communication and structured feedback loop.

## Software Technologies Limited – Human Resource Officer

November 2021 – October 2024

- Managed full-cycle recruitment, onboarding, and offboarding processes.
- Implemented a Photography Policy after legal review to safeguard intellectual property.
- Introduced end-of-year recognition programmes that boosted employee morale and improved culture.
- Advocated for and implemented an ATS, reducing recruitment timelines by 30%.
- Managed payroll, benefits, and leave administration in line with company policies.
- Supported disciplinary processes and conflict resolution to maintain workplace harmony.

## Accurex Leadership Management – Human Resource Officer

November 2020 – October 2021

- Supported policy development, HR records, compliance reporting, employee engagement and training coordination.
- Managed recruitment coordination, onboarding and offboarding, employee and tax documentation, background/reference checks and employee queries.
- Administered payroll, benefits and leave processes and supported disciplinary and conflict-resolution matters.
- Implemented a Photography Policy after legal review and introduced recognition programmes to strengthen employee morale and culture.
- Advocated for and implemented an ATS, reducing recruitment timelines by 30%.

## Africa Rafikis Limited – Human Resource Assistant

Jul 2016 – Jun 2017

- Supported end-to-end recruitment processes, including drafting job descriptions, posting vacancies, screening CVs, and coordinating interviews.
- Assisted in onboarding and orientation programmes for new employees, ensuring smooth integration into the company culture.
- Maintained and updated employee records, both physical and digital, in compliance with data protection policies.
- Assisted in preparing monthly payroll inputs, verifying attendance and leave records before submission.
- Helped organise staff training sessions and development programmes to improve skills and performance.
- Monitored employee leave balances and benefits administration in line with company policy.
- Supported the HR Manager in handling employee grievances and disciplinary processes.
- Prepared HR-related reports for management decision-making.

## REFEREES

Upon request